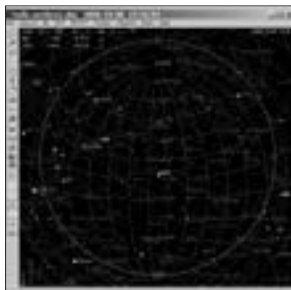


9.6 Hallo Northern Sky

www.hnsky.org/software.htm#hnsky

“Hallo northern sky” or HNSKY is a free planetarium program for Windows. Have a go at it! You get 26,000 deep-sky objects and all stars to magnitude 12 (a measure of brightness). You’ll be able to see all the planets, the Moon, Sun, the moons of Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Uranus and Neptune, and a few hundred asteroids and comets. The program comes with 255 small DSS (Digitized Sky Survey) deep-sky images.



HNS offers a map of *your* sky

First enter your co-ordinates—this is a simple matter of dragging the mouse to where you live—and you’re set. Then, when you’re connected to the Internet, you can download DSS files in the FITS format (Flexible Image Transfer System is the most commonly used file format in astronomy). This valuable astronomer’s resource displays astronomical images for anywhere in the sky you point and click.



As in Celestia, choose a heavenly object from a list

If you don’t own a telescope then this is the perfect way to experience the sky! And if you do own a telescope, this is the perfect tool to assist you in locating interesting objects to observe or photograph.

Getting around the program can be both simple and complex. It’s simple to use the “Go To” function and visit Saturn, Uranus, etc., but when you click “go left”, the program rotates left—just